

6.4 Pornography

What percentage of the Internet is made up of pornography? Some say almost half the Internet is porn! While this may be an exaggeration, close to 20 per cent of the Web sites on the World Wide Web are dedicated to pornography.

Pornography is not only images, but also videos and stories. Pornographic material is also one of the most-searched for on the Internet. According to Google, 68 million searches are made every day for some variation of the word “porn”.



Pornography Is Morphing Into A Menace

So why is pornography regarded as a threat? It is not pornography per sé that is harmful to the user. It's not a virus or a worm that would destroy or corrupt an important file on your computer. Neither is it some software that would 'phish' out your personal details. The reason behind pornography being vilified is the fact that it becomes highly addictive. Being freely available in abundance on the Internet makes it the most surfed content. Excessive viewing of pornography has a detrimental effect on an individual's personal and social life.

Most of the successful Internet entrepreneurs are those who own pornographic sites. So much so, that post the dot com bust, of all the start ups that actually made profits, a large percentage were pornography providers. With rapid technological advancements in interactive software development, some sites offer inter-